



DAY 24: JAVASCRIPT EVENT LOOP & MICROTASKS



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Have you ever wondered how JavaScript handles multiple tasks efficiently, even though it's single-threaded? 🤔

The secret lies in the Event Loop, which manages the execution of synchronous and asynchronous tasks. Let's break it down! 👉

◆ What is the JavaScript Event Loop?

JavaScript is single-threaded, meaning it executes code one line at a time in the call stack. But what if we have an async operation like:

- ✓ Fetching API data
- ✓ Handling user interactions
- ✓ Running setTimeout

This is where the Event Loop steps in to manage asynchronous tasks without blocking the main thread. 🚀

◆ JavaScript Execution Flow

JavaScript executes code in the following order:

- 1 Call Stack → Runs synchronous code (LIFO: Last In, First Out)
- 2 Web APIs → Handles async tasks like setTimeout, DOM events, fetch, etc.
- 3 Callback Queue → Stores setTimeout & setInterval callbacks
- 4 Microtask Queue → Stores Promises & MutationObserver callbacks (higher priority than Callback Queue)
- 5 Event Loop → Moves tasks from queues to the Call Stack when it's empty

◆ Understanding the Call Stack

- 📌 The Call Stack is where JavaScript executes functions in LIFO order.

```
function first() {  
    console.log("First function");  
}  
function second() {  
    console.log("Second function");  
}  
first();  
second();  
console.log("End of script");
```

◆ Output:

```
First function  
Second function  
End of script
```

- ✓ Since all functions are synchronous, they execute immediately in the Call Stack.

How Asynchronous Tasks Work? (setTimeout Example)

```
console.log("Start");  
setTimeout(() => {  
    console.log("Inside setTimeout");  
}, 0);  
console.log("End");
```

◆ Output:

```
Start  
End  
Inside setTimeout
```

✓ Even though `setTimeout` is `ons`, it doesn't run immediately because it moves to the Callback Queue, and JavaScript first finishes executing synchronous code.

◆ Microtask Queue vs Callback Queue

The Microtask Queue has higher priority than the Callback Queue.

📌 Microtasks:

- Promises (`.then()` & `.catch()`)
- MutationObserver

📌 Callback Queue:

- `setTimeout`
- `setInterval`

Example: Microtasks vs Callback Queue

```
console.log("Start");  
setTimeout(() => {  
  console.log("setTimeout");  
}, 0);  
  
Promise.resolve().then(() => {  
  console.log("Promise resolved");  
});  
console.log("End");
```

◆ Output:

Start

End

Promise resolved

setTimeout

✓ Even though setTimeout has 0ms, the Promise executes first because Microtasks always run before Callback Queue.

◆ Event Loop in Action

- 1 Synchronous code runs first (Call Stack)
- 2 Microtasks (Promises) execute next
- 3 Callbacks (setTimeout, setInterval) run last

Example: Event Loop Execution

```
console.log("1");  
setTimeout(() => console.log("2"), 0);  
Promise.resolve().then(() =>  
  console.log("3"));  
console.log("4");
```


◆ Execution Order:

1

4

3  (Microtask runs before setTimeout)

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